

MATTHEW NIBLOE

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BUSINESS ADDRESS

University College London
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PERSONAL INFORMATION

Citizenship: British

EDUCATION

PhD in Economics, University College London	2021 - Present
MRes in Economics, University College London	2020 - 2021
MSc in Economics, University College London	2019 - 2020
BSc in Economics and Econometrics, University of Nottingham	2016 - 2019

REFERENCES

Christian Dustmann
Professor of Economics
University College London
Drayton House
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Professor of Economics
University of Hong Kong
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Sir Richard Blundell
David Ricardo Professor of Political Economy
University College London
Drayton House
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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Labour Economics, Public Economics, International Trade

WORKING PAPERS

[JMP] The Labour Market Consequences of Trade Disintegration: Evidence from Brexit.
With J. Knuf and A. Tang.

The Distributional Consequences of Public Pay Caps (submitted).

We study the distributional consequences of a common post-financial-crisis policy: public-sector pay caps. In the UK, caps limited nominal pay growth to 1% from 2010 to 2017 for public workers earning above £21,000 (15% of employees). Using counterfactual distribution methods, we find larger public wage losses at P90 than P50. The caps reduced the overall P90–P50 gap by 2.3pp by 2019, fully accounting for the observed decline in inequality, while widening gender and regional wage gaps by 0.9pp and 0.4pp. The contemporaneous decline in public-sector employment approximately doubled regional and gender effects to 1.9pp (17.5%) and 0.7pp (9.9%).

Low-wage Work and Labour Market Policies: A European Cross-country Study (submitted).

With T. Schack, J. Meekes, C. Barreto, S. Carcillo, J. Fluchtmann, A. Hijzen, B. Lochner, and R. Vejlin.

We study the incidence, sources, and dynamics of low-wage employment using harmonised linked employer-employee administrative data from Denmark, France, Germany, the Netherlands, Portugal, and the United Kingdom. We define low-wage employment relative to the country-specific median hourly wage and examine how worker characteristics, firm-specific wage premia, wage progression, and labour market institutions shape outcomes at different parts of the lower wage distribution. Three main findings emerge. First, worker characteristics account for most of the wage gap facing low-wage workers, though firm-specific wage premia matter too, especially at the very bottom, where they are around half as large as the worker component. These firm premia reflect both sorting across industries and pay

differences across firms within industries. Second, low-wage employment is at least partly transitory, as workers at the bottom see faster subsequent wage growth and change firms more often. Third, minimum wages and marginal effective tax rates show limited systematic association with wage growth or job-to-job mobility, though higher minimum wages are linked to a smaller share of workers below 70% of the median. These patterns are broadly similar across countries and point to the joint importance of worker skills and access to higher-paying firms for improving low-wage workers' prospects.

Early Skills, Environments and Lifecycle Profiles of Earnings and Health.

With P. Carneiro and S. Cattan.

We employ machine learning sequence analysis techniques to study lifetime trajectories of wages and health in the UK. We establish the presence of deep and persistent multidimensional inequality that is exacerbated over the lifecycle. In particular, we highlight the presence of a large group of deprived men and women who rarely enter employment and consistently score the lowest among their peers on common measures of mental and physical health. Trajectories are strongly correlated with cognitive, internalising, and externalising skills in childhood, with associations generally strongest for skills measured later in childhood, particularly internalising skills at age 16. Childhood environments are also important: greater parental time and socioeconomic status are associated with a lower probability of deprivation, whereas hospitalisation at age 11 is associated with a higher probability of deprivation over the lifecycle. A flexible neural network that takes skills, environments, and basic demographic factors as inputs can accurately predict deprivation, providing policymakers with a tool for targeted implementation.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Technological Innovations and Worker Skills

With J. Onken and Y. Shen.

Capping Student Outcomes: The Long-Term Consequences of Teacher Pay Restraint

RESEARCH GRANTS AND AWARDS

PhD Scholar Research Grant - James M. and Cathleen D. Stone Centre at UCL	2025
PhD Enrichment Scholarship - Institute for Fiscal Studies	2024
PhD Studentship - Centre for Research and Analysis of Migration	2023
UCL Student Choice Award for Inspiring Teaching (Honour Roll)	2023
Best Final Year Teaching Assistant in UCL Department of Economics	2023
Best Final Year Teaching Assistant in UCL Department of Economics	2022

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development	London, England
Consultant, Directorate for Employment, Labour and Social Affairs	2025 - Present
Intern	2025
UCL Stone Centre	London, England
PhD Scholar	2025 - Present
ROCKWOOL Foundation Berlin	Berlin, Germany
Research Affiliate	2024 - Present
Institute for Fiscal Studies	London, England
Research Scholar	2022 - Present
PhD Enrichment Student	2024 - 2025
Centre for Research and Analysis of Migration (CReAM)	London, England
Research Officer	2022 - Present

CONFERENCES & INVITED TALKS

2026	Prime Minister's Office (London, UK) RF Berlin and CReAM Annual Summer Workshop (Nizza Monferrato, IT) Asia Meeting of the Econometric Society (Hong Kong) Society of Labor Economics Annual Meeting (Denver, US)
2025	Econometric Society World Congress (Seoul, KR) Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (Paris, FR) Institute for Fiscal Studies (London, UK) Warwick CAGE Conference* (Warwick, UK) HEC Paris PhD Conference* (Paris, FR)
2024	Asian-Australasian Society of Labor Economics Annual Conference (Bangkok, TH) UCL Applied Research Day (London, UK) Stone Centre Annual Conference (London, UK) RF Berlin and CReAM Annual Summer Workshop (Nizza Monferrato, IT)

* Joint work presented by a co-author.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

ECON0021: Microeconometrics (UCL) Departmental teaching prize, university-wide teaching prize	2021-2025
ECON0024: Economic Policy Analysis (UCL) Departmental teaching prize	2021-2024

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Amazon Intern, Economic Decision Science	London, England 2022
Caxton Associates Intern, Portfolio Management	London, England 2018
Insight Investment Intern, Multi Asset Strategy Group	London, England 2017

POLICY ARTICLES

Who Enters the Public Sector? <i>With C. von Bismarck Osten — FT coverage</i>
Economic Lessons from 25 Years of Devolution <i>With D. Knight and C. May</i>

TECHNICAL AND LANGUAGE SKILLS

Technical: Python, R, MATLAB, Stata, MS Office.
Languages: English (native), German (beginner), French (beginner).